

Standard Chartered

Strong performance with momentum across the business; Guidance appears conservative

StanChart's 3Q results are strong with pre-provision profits 10% ahead of expectations, with NII 2% ahead, non-NII 4% ahead led by Wealth (+27% y/y) and Banking (+23% y/y) although with Markets weaker as previously flagged (+1% y/y with flow income +12% y/y), and costs 1% lower. Balance sheet momentum remained strong with underlying loans +1% q/q and deposits +2% q/q. Impairments were well managed at 24bps CoR, leading to PBT 14% ahead of expectations and driving CET1 to 14.2% 10bps ahead. The Group has upgraded FY25E total revenue guidance to the upper end of the 5-7% range (vs cons c7%) with NII guidance unchanged which looks conservative, in our view, considering the strong 3Q performance. Underlying FY25E ROTE is now expected at c13% with cons in line and one year ahead of plan. Updated 2026 ROTE guidance will be provided in Feb '26 and the Group will share MT targets in May '26 where we expect the positive ROTE trajectory to continue. Overall, we expect low-single-digit EPS upgrades to consensus expectations across 25-27E driven by stronger revenues. We remain OW, with the stock trading on 7.5x PE, 0.9x PTNAV for an Adj ROTE of 13.3% 27E.

- **Noteworthy Areas:** 1) NII of \$2.7bn was 2% above cons and +1% q/q driven by volume growth partly offset by lower rates; pass-through rates in CIB continue to be better than MT expectations. AIEAs were +2% q/q with underlying loans +1% q/q driven by WRB +\$2bn q/q while CIB loans were flat, and underlying deposits were +2% q/q driven by WRB (+\$7bn) and CIB deposits (+\$4bn q/q) largely in CASA and Treasury. 2) Other income of \$2.4bn was 4% ahead of cons. Total income was \$5.1bn and 3% ahead. 3) Costs of \$3.0bn were 1% below cons, driving PPOP of \$2.2bn 10% ahead of cons. 4) Credit impairments of \$195m (24bps CoR) were below cons \$252m (and included a \$25mn overlay for HK CRE), driving underlying PBT of \$2.0bn 14% ahead of cons, while Reported PBT of \$1.8bn was 16% ahead of cons. 5) CET1 of 14.2% was 10bps ahead with RWAs in line; Minimum CET1 requirement now 10.2% (prev 10.5%) driven by Pillar 2A reduction 6) TNAV/sh of 1,684c was in line with cons.
- **Outlook & Guidance: 2025 income and RoTE guidance upgraded.** 1) 2025 income growth is now expected to be at the top end of the 5-7% range from a 2024 base of \$19.3bn (prev around bottom of 5-7% range) vs cons 6.9% against this base. Within this, NII is still expected to be down LSD% y/y const FX vs cons -c2%. 2) 2025 underlying RoTE expected to be ~13% (compared to prev guidance of RoTE approaching 13% in 2026) vs cons 13.1%. **Other guidance remains unchanged:** 1) 2026 cost guidance is reiterated on a const FX basis at below \$12.3bn which is \$12.4bn on current 2026 fwd FX rates (cons \$12.4bn). 2) The Group continues to track towards the upper end of the 5-7% CAGR range for 23-26E revenues, with a FY23 const FX base of c\$17.4bn, implying c\$21.2bn FY26E assuming 6.5% CAGR (vs cons \$21.1bn).
- **Performance by key product segments (const-FX):** 3Q: Global Markets

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Overweight

STAN.L, STAN LN

Price (29 Oct 25): 1,516p

Price Target (Dec-26): 1690.0p

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+1% y/y (9% below cons) with Macro -1% y/y and Credit +18% y/y; Global Markets driven by Flow income (+12% y/y) while episodic income was subdued (-36% y/y). Global Banking +24% y/y (10% above cons) with Lending & Fin Solutions +22% y/y and Capital Markets & Advisory +35% y/y. Wealth +28% y/y (16% above cons) with \$13.3bn net new money (+28% y/y, \$42bn YTD at 15% growth of AUM, compared to c\$200bn 5Y target from 2025) and c67k new-to-bank affluent clients onboarded (c200k YTD and >60k average over the past six quarters).

- **Likely changes to consensus:** The Group has upgraded FY25E total revenue guidance to the upper end of the 5-7% range (vs cons c7% on the 2024 base) with NII still expected to be down LSD%. Assuming a 2% decline in FY25E, NII would imply a c4% q/q NII decline for 4Q25E and 4Q25E non-NII +7% y/y, which we view as conservative. Assuming a 1% decline in FY25E NII would imply flat q/q NII for 4Q25E and 4Q25E non-NII +1% y/y. Therefore, we expect LSD% EPS upgrades on slightly stronger revenues for 25-27E.
- **Conference Call Details:** 08.00 UK [here](#)

Actual vs Expected:

Table 1: StanChart 3Q Group results

\$mn

	3Q24	2Q25	3Q25E	3Q25 Cons	3Q25A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMc	Y/Y	Q/Q
NII	2,769	2,703	2,668	2,672	2,737	2%	3%	-1%	1%
Other Income	2,123	2,806	2,306	2,309	2,410	4%	5%	14%	-14%
Revenue	4,892	5,509	4,973	4,981	5,147	3%	3%	5%	-7%
o.w. Transaction Services	1,572	1,469	1,431	1,461	1,488	2%	4%	-5%	1%
o.w. Global Banking	475	548	548	534	588	10%	7%	24%	7%
o.w. Global Markets	840	1,172	913	929	848	-9%	-7%	1%	-28%
o.w. Wealth Solutions	694	742	793	764	890	16%	12%	28%	20%
Operating expenses	-2,840	-3,050	-2,995	-2,980	-2,953	-1%	-1%	4%	-3%
Pre-provision operating profit	2,052	2,459	1,978	2,001	2,194	10%	11%	7%	-11%
Loan impairments	-178	-117	-210	-252	-195	-23%	-7%	10%	67%
Profits pre-Other impairments/Assocs	1,874	2,342	1,768	1,749	1,999	14%	13%	7%	-15%
Other impairments	-92	-3	-9	-19	-20	5%			
Profit from associates	13	64	10	11	6	-45%	-40%	-54%	-91%
Clean Pretax profits	1,795	2,403	1,770	1,741	1,985	14%	12%	11%	-17%
Exceptional items	-73	-123	-250	-221	-219	-1%	-12%	200%	78%
Pretax profits	1,722	2,280	1,520	1,520	1,766	16%	16%	3%	-23%
CET1 ratio	14.2%	14.3%	14.0%	14.1%	14.2%				
RWAs	249	260	262	259	258	0%	-1%	4%	0%
Customer deposits	478	517	514	516	526	2%	2%	10%	2%

Note:
Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Table 2: StanChart 3Q product revenues

\$mn

	3Q24	2Q25	3Q25E	3Q25 Cons	3Q25A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMc	Y/Y	Q/Q
Transaction Services	1,572	1,469	1,431	1,461	1,488	2%	4%	-5%	1%
Payments and Liquidity	1,112	1,013	983	1,000	1,016	2%	3%	-9%	0%
Securities Services	156	158	159	160	166	4%	4%	6%	5%
Trade & Working Capital	304	298	289	301	306	2%	6%	1%	3%
Banking	475	548	548	534	588	10%	7%	24%	7%
Lending & Financial Solutions	407	476	452	455	496	9%	10%	22%	4%
Capital Maket & Advisory	68	72	96	79	92	16%	-4%	35%	28%
Markets	840	1,172	913	929	848	-9%	-7%	1%	-28%
Macro Trading	683	961	750	763	678	-11%	-10%	-1%	-29%
Credit Trading	174	187	168	176	206	17%	22%	18%	10%
Valuation & Other Adj	-17	24	-5	-7	-36	414%	620%	112%	-250%
Wealth Solutions	694	742	793	764	890	16%	12%	28%	20%
Investment Products	507	544	582	557	691	24%	19%	36%	27%
Bancassurance	187	198	211	203	199	-2%	-6%	6%	1%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	281	282	276	278	277	0%	0%	-1%	-2%
Deposits & Mortgages	1,051	990	960	984	1,034	5%	8%	-2%	4%
Ventures	43	278	59	59	39	-34%	-34%	-9%	-86%
Digital Banks	39	46	55	51	49	-4%	-	-	-
SCV	4	232	4	9	-10	-211%	-	-	-
Treasury & Other	-64	28	-7	-8	-17	113%	-	-	-
Total underlying operating income	4,892	5,509	4,973	5,001	5,147	3%	3%	5%	-7%

Note:

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Standard Chartered (Overweight; Price Target: 1690.0p)

Investment Thesis

We view StanChart as undervalued relative to the sector/EM peers at 1.0x PTNAV with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. We expect a c7% revenue growth CAGR across '23-26E driven by non-NII led by Wealth (driven by Affluent segment opportunities) and Financial Markets (alongside cross-border income), with the Group's previous investments producing revenue momentum. NII is likely to be under pressure in 25E from lower rates, albeit partly offset in the medium term by a better outlook from loan growth, management actions (e.g. growth in higher margin areas) and a growing hedge - although we highlight growing risks from trade tensions. We expect cost growth at a c4% CAGR, with the Group's restructuring programme expected to drive material cost saves from FY26E, supporting PPOP CAGR of 12% and RoTE improving to 12.7% by FY26E and further thereafter. Capital remains strong and we forecast distributions of c\$10.7bn compared to Group targets of >\$8bn 24-26E, and we expect a further \$1.5bn of share buybacks in 4Q25. CRE remains a risk, although we see the Group as better positioned compared to peers and pro-actively managing higher-risk exposures lower.

Valuation

We value Standard Chartered using a SOTP methodology with divisional multiples differentiated by type of business. We value Corporate, Commercial and Institutional Banking at 8.0x P/E, and Consumer, Private and Business Banking Commercial at 8.5x P/E, and Ventures at 1x book. We value excess capital above 13.0% at 1x. Our Dec-26 price target is 1,690p.

Standard Chartered: SOP-based Valuation

£ MILLION Division	Post Tax Profit 2027E	Allocated B4 Equity 2027E	RWAs £ bn 2027E	Valuation Basis	£ mn Value	£ Per Share	(x) PE	(x) P/BV
Corporate, Commercial & Institutional Banking	3,233	20,382	156.8	P/E	25,867	12.53	8.0	
Consumer, Private and Business Banking	1,843	6,582	50.6	P/E	15,664	7.59	8.5	
Ventures	-80	665	5.1	P/B	665	0.32		1.0
Corporate centre and other	-674	1,775	13.7	P/E	-6,064	-2.94	9.0	
Capital Excess		2,302		1 times BV	2,302	1.11		1.0
Capital Returns above ord dividends						0.00		
Standard Chartered Group	4,322	31,705	226.2		38,433	18.6	8.9	
Standard Chartered Group (Dec-2026)						16.9		

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

- **Macroeconomic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macroeconomic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross border and political risks. COVID-19 continues to be a risk towards revenues and impairments in the near term, particularly in Asian economies, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
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risk to our forecasts.

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Standard Chartered (STAN.L, STAN LN) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
06-Dec-22	OW	592	800
27-Feb-23	OW	771	1,000
17-Apr-23	OW	646	970
01-Aug-23	OW	747	980
07-Sep-23	OW	702	990
16-Jan-24	OW	605	820
26-Feb-24	OW	635	850
10-Apr-24	OW	673	900
03-May-24	OW	756	1,000
31-Jul-24	OW	770	1,020
04-Dec-24	OW	966	1,180
24-Feb-25	OW	1183	1,390
04-Aug-25	OW	1355	1,490
09-Sep-25	OW	1391	1,670
17-Oct-25	OW	1428	1,690

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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